MOUNTAIN REVIEW
OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
Volume IX | Issue IV | Fall 2019



Page 4
An update on the status of two historic downtown buildings.



Page 5
The history of the original Eagle Shack.

SUMMER BBQ Snapshots

Page 6
Check out some rad photos from our MV in the 80s BBQ!

YOU ARE INVITED!





Back to the EAGLE SHACK

MVHA Fall Event

ABOUT THE EVENT

Join us on Sunday, October 6 from 1:00 to 4:00 p.m. for an afternoon of music and memories as we bring back the "Eagle Shack!" From 1944 until the early 1950s, the historic Adobe Building was also known as the "Eagle Shack," named after the mascot of Mountain View Union High School (MVUHS). On Saturday nights teens would turn the Adobe into a dance hall as local bands played popular tunes. Longtime MVHA member Eugene Sharp (MVUHS Class of 1949) last brought the Eagle Shack back to life in 2007, and we're excited to partner with him again for this event. We'll have live music and light refreshments, the dance floor will be open, historic MVUHS memorabilia will be on display, and we'll have an open mic for attendees to share their high school memories. We are especially excited to welcome Jeff Melenudo, MVP of the Eagles' 1975 championship football team to share his memories of that remarkable year for MVUHS. This event is free for MVHA members with a suggested donation of $10 for non-members/guests. Everyone is encouraged to get into the spirit of the event by wearing your high school colors or outfits inspired by the original 1940s/50s Eagle Shack era. We hope to see you there!

LIVE MUSIC BY MV HIGH'S "FIFTH EDITION"

In the spirit of student-musicians performing at the original Eagle Shack dances, the MVHA is very excited to welcome "Fifth Edition," Mtn. View High School's five-piece music combo, as our featured performers at the Back to the Eagle Shack event.

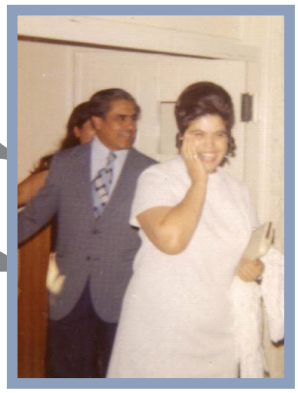
Come support these Mtn. View High Spartans as they fill the historic Adobe Building with timeless tunes that span generations during the first hour of our October 6 event.; they're currently scheduled to perform from 1:30 to 2:30 p.m. Schedule subject to change; check our eventbrite page for the latest info!



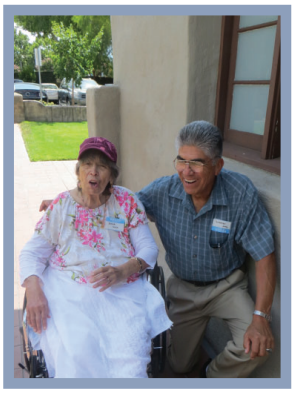
RSVP at: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 6, 2019 ● 1:00-4:00 P.M. ● THE HISTORIC ADOBE BUILDING, 157 MOFFETT BLVD., MTN. VIEW, CA

News & Notes







President's Message

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA President

Since it was built in 1934, the Adobe Building has been a center of community life in Mountain View. If this venerable structure's old adobe-brick walls could talk, they'd tell stories of World War II servicemen getting some much needed R&R before deployment, joyous wedding celebrations, numerous fraternal club and non-profit meetings (like ours!), birthday parties, anniversaries, classes, dances, and more.

Chances are if you've lived in Mountain View long enough, you have at least one memory inside the historic Adobe. The snapshots above capture a few from my own family's history. Pictured on the left is my grandparents' surprise 25th anniversary celebration in 1973. It captures the moment they walked into the Adobe and the joyous look of surprise on their faces as they were greeted by dozens of family members and friends. The photo in the center shows them again at the Adobe, this time at my uncle's wedding, walking him down the aisle in the Adobe's garden. And the photo on the right shows my grandma and her brother at the MVHA's Summer BBQ in 2014, the last of many events she attended at the building.

I treasure the happy memories I've made in the Adobe and I hope you'll join me to make some more as we pay tribute to the building's historic role as the "Eagle Shack" at our Sunday, October 6 event and membership meeting. For the generation of Mountain View High School alumni who lived here in the 1940s and 1950s, the Adobe is still fondly remembered as the Eagle Shack, where teens from the city and surrounding countryside gathered on Saturday nights for live music and dancing. Our "Back to the Eagle Shack" event will be a tribute to that era with a special focus on the spirit and history of old Mountain View High.

And while we hope a large "flock" of Mountain View High Eagle alumni will join us as part of the larger "All Eagle" annual reunion weekend*, this event is open to all and free to our members. So whether you were a Mtn. View/Awalt Spartan, a Los Altos Eagle, a St. Francis Lancer, (like me!) or graduated from another alma mater, I encourage you to muster some old school spirit and come to the Adobe for what is sure to be a memorable afternoon of music, dance, food and fun.

See you at the Adobe!

—Nick

**According to our sources on Facebook, the annual All-Eagle alumni picnic will be held on Saturday, October 5, the day before our event, at the Cuesta Park picnic grounds from 10:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.*

MOUNTAIN VIEW REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

MVHA Board of Directors

President: Nicholas Perry
Vice-President: Robert Cox
Secretary: Jamil Shaikh
Treasurer: Emily Ramos
Past President: Candace Bowers
Historical Data: Melissa Wright
Membership: Lisa Roquero Garcia
Newsletter: John Cortez
Ways & Means: Mark Perry
Director-at-Large: Marina Marinovich
Director-at-Large: Gil Lane

Newsletter Copy Editor: Cynthia Hanson
Newsletter Graphic Designer: Nick Perry

MVHA Board of Directors
Email: info@mountainviewhistorical.org
Voicemail: (650) 903-6890



Retro Mtn. View

MVHA's Online Clothing Shop Now Open!

Looking to add some hometown pride to your wardrobe? Then check out the MVHA's online clothing shop where we're selling designs inspired by local history: Mountain View Eagle gear, Awalt Spartan gear, our popular Linda's Drive-In design, t-shirts in men's and women's styles, sweatshirts, tanks, and more! And if you have ideas for other Mountain View-themed shirts you'd like to see added to the store, contact us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org. All proceeds go to supporting the MVHA and our mission to preserve and share Mountain View's history. Visit the shop at:

teespring.com/stores/retromv

Welcome Mark Perry to the Board!

MVHA Board of Directors



The Board of Directors is very happy to announce that Mark Perry has volunteered to join the Board and fill the vacant position of Ways & Means Committee Chair. The official duty of the Ways & Means Committee Chair is "to formulate plans for the raising of funds for special projects of the Association," and Mark is a perfect fit for this role. A native of Mountain View and a proud alumni of old Mountain View High (Class of 1975), Mark brings both a passion for his hometown's history and decades of experience in sales and marketing to the position.

Those of you who have attended recent meetings and events should recognize his face; Mark has frequently volunteered with the MVHA in the past. He's also the father of our current president! Please join us in welcoming Mark to the Board. Look for him at future events manning our merchandise table where he'll be working to raise funds for the association through history book and T-shirt sales.

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos

MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 6/25/2019: $23,694.16

- Income: $1,792.05
- Expenses: $2,013.62

Checking Account Balance as of 9/2/2019: $23,472.59

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 6/25/2019: $60,299.09

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/2/2019: $60,229.09

MVHA Board Updates

By Nicholas Perry

MVHA President

Updates from our last Board of Directors Meeting, held on August 28, 2019:

Non-Profit Status: Good news! The association's tax-exempt status has been officially restored by the State of California Franchise Tax Board. A special note of appreciation to former President Nick Galiotto for his guidance as we worked to resolve the paperwork issues with the state.

Khan Lab Partnership: The Board agreed to partner with 1st and 2nd grade teachers at the Khan Lab school on Villa Street on "Mountain View, Wherever," a local history project that will teach students about the history of our city, as well as other towns named Mountain View throughout the country.

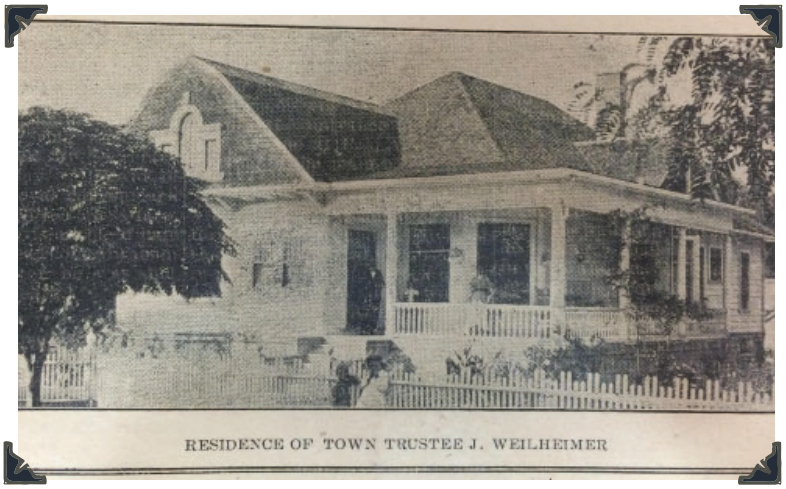
1975 Eagles CCS Championship Monument: The Board unanimously voted to write a letter of support for the group working to install a monument at Eagle Park honoring the Mtn. View High School 1975 football championship team (see article in our Spring 2019 newsletter for more information).

Veterans Memorial Interpretive Sign: The Mtn. View Veterans Memorial interpretive sign, co-funded by the MVHA, should be installed at Eagle Park by early November. The sign describes the meaning of the veterans' memorial and the history of Eagle Park.

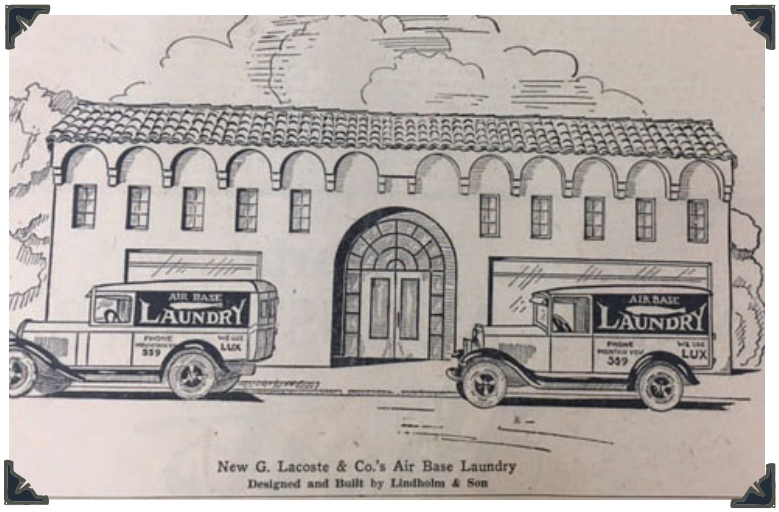
Our next Board of Directors Meeting is scheduled for December 11, 2019 from 6:00 to 8:00 p.m. at the History Center at the Mountain View Library. Interested members are welcome to attend!

Weilheimer House & Air Base Laundry Buildings Found Eligible for State Historic Register

Editor's Note: *The following article is adapted from a press release shared with the MVHA by the group Livable Mountain View. For more information visit: www.livablemv.org.*



The Weilheimer House as featured on the front page of the Mtn. View *Register* on March 5, 1905.



A rendering of the Air Base Laundry appeared on the front page of the 1931 Mountain View *Register-Leader*

The California State Historical Resources Commission (SHRC) determined the Weilheimer House (presently home to Chez TJ restaurant) and the former Air Base Laundry building (presently home to the Tied House Cafe and Brewery) are eligible for the National Register of Historic Places, following a formal nomination of each building for historic designation by the group Livable Mountain View. By virtue of the SHRC determining the buildings' eligibility, both the Weilheimer House and former Air Base Laundry building, located adjacent to one another on Villa Street in Downtown Mountain View, are now listed on the California Register of Historical Resources.

Appointed by the governor of California, the SHRC is a nine-member state review board responsible for identifying, registering, and preserving California's cultural heritage. Its members include experts in history, prehistoric archaeology, architectural history, and restoration architecture. During its public hearing in Sacramento earlier this year, the SHRC reviewed Livable Mountain View's nominations, which included extensive written documentation and visual materials supporting the historical and architectural significance of the Weilheimer House and former Air Base Laundry. The commission then voted 7-0 (two commissioners were absent) to support the buildings' eligibility and later rendered formal decisions on both.

The Weilheimer House was built in 1894 by Julius Weilheimer, son of Seligman Weilheimer, a German-Jewish immigrant who in 1853, along with his brother, settled in Mountain View. The Weilheimers opened a general store, followed by many other family businesses that included a hotel, a livery, and additional general stores. Julius Weilheimer was born in Mountain View in 1860 and eventually ran many of the family businesses, which by then were located on and around Castro Street. He served as trustee, mayor (he held city council meetings in the Weilheimer House), and vice-president of the local bank, and led the effort to rebuild Mountain View's downtown after the destruction caused by the 1906 earthquake.

The Weilheimer House's next resident was five-term U.S. Congressman Arthur Free, who was responsible for Moffett Field (later Moffett Field/Ames Research) coming to Mountain View in 1930, when cities up and down California were competing for this project.

Built in 1931, the Air Base Laundry largely served the base and thus was designed to match the 30 Spanish Revival buildings still located at Moffett Field, all of which are on the National Register of Historic Places. Its façade remains unchanged as it retains its stucco finish, red roof, original upper story windows, and corbels below the roofline. Although updated since 1931, the materials and scale of the doors and windows are consistent with that of the original building. By history, function, and design, the Air Base Laundry building is Downtown Mountain View's link to the first generation of air and space technology—events that helped to lay the foundation for today's Silicon Valley.

Special Feature
History of the Eagle Shack



By Eugene Sharp
MVHA Member



The Eagle Shack opening Night, November 17, 1944

Editor's Note: *Eugene Sharp is a longtime MVHA volunteer, MVHS class of 1949 alumni, and former member of the "Melody Mixers" band, which performed at the Eagle(s) Shack from 1947–51. He originally wrote this article in anticipation of the 2007 revival of the Eagle Shack; an event that drew over 100 people for dancing, music, and memories shared with friends old and new. We're looking forward to doing it all again at our Oct. 6 event!*

Was the Eagles Shack a real structure? The Eagles Shack seemed to be an imaginary place disguised inside the solid Adobe Building, coming to life only on selected Saturday evenings in a town recently founded, in a place where eagles have flown for millennia.

Early in February of 1943, the second year of World War II, the Adobe building was used as a Service Men's Club. As reported in the *Mountain View Register-Leader (MVRL)* on February 3, 1943, "The first order of business undertaken by the city council last night. . . was hearing of arrangements made by the executive committee recently organized to handle the affairs of the Service Men's Hospitality House and accept its petition for the use of the Adobe Building as a recreation center for service men either stationed or visiting here."

Within two weeks support blossomed. Wood was donated for the huge fireplace, bookcases were provided for either side of the fireplace, other donations included "coffee, sugar, shortening and other items so that cookies can be baked in plain sight and—smell—of boys that miss the home kitchen . . . . coins for the juke box, records, ping pong table. According to the paper, "Articles needed included writing tables, 'sitting' chairs for our men and women guests, not those heartless things that are offered at the chamber of commerce meetings and in large part account for the poor attendance at the infrequent membership meetings."

The Eagles Shack coexisted with the Service Men's Club at the Adobe, and was conceived at a meeting held on December 5, 1944, and, according to the MVRL, "attended by nearly four score residents, representing nearly all active organizations of this community" where "Judge J. M. Atkinson acting as temporary chairman explained the aims and objects of the project, giving it as his opinion, based upon much court dealings with youth, that supervised recreation is a big force in combating youthful delinquency." By December 11, 1944, the paper reported that "Saturday night at the Adobe was another indication of the interest the young folks of the community are taking in the matter of suitable recreation."

In early 1949, a four-page folder titled "The Eagle Shack" was published "dedicated to youth by youth." About 2,800 copies of "The Eagle Shack" were distributed to principal towns in Northern California and recreation leaders in the state. Anyone knowing of a copy of this document is asked to notify the MVHA so it can be added to the archives. The Eagles Shack or Eagle Shack, as MVUHS '49ers knew it, continued into the early 1950s. Around 1956 it moved to the Sunnyview Club, which later became the Mtn. View Senior Center.



The "Melody Mixers" in 1948 with author Eugene Sharp playing clarinet in front of the piano.

Summer BBQ Snapshots

MTN. VIEW IN THE 1980S



After a "Mountain View in the 1980s" slideshow talk by MVHA President Nick Perry, the Honorable Leslie Nichols, former Santa Clara County Superior Court Judge and Mayor of Mountain View in 1979-80, shared his memories of Mountain View at the beginning of the 1980s.



Guests enjoyed browsing through the 1980s artifacts and ephemera from the MVHA archives at the Mountain View History Center.



It was an honor to have Mountain View Mayor Lisa Matichak, Vice-Mayor Margaret Abe-Koga and Councilmember Lucas Ramirez join us for the festivities!



It was a beautiful day to sit outside in the Adobe Building garden!



We loved Karen's vintage 1980s outfit! Especially her rad "Spuds MacKenzie" kicks!





A recreation of Linda's Drive-In "Parisian Burgers" from the Gold Rush Eatery gave guests a delicious taste of Mountain View History.



This little guy was very excited to take our 1980s decorations home! They were handmade by MVHA member Gloria Perry (thanks Gloria!)

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
Membership Chair

It was great seeing so many of you at the BBQ. I hope you all enjoyed the great food and learning about the 80s. Thank you for all the membership renewals; please keep them coming! A special welcome to our new members:

- Savannah Carroll-Munoz
- Karen DeMello
- Christine Ebangi, Life Member
- Fred Greguras
- Frank Navarro
- Kay Partelow
- Jean Weston

Also, thank you Elaine Rossignol for becoming a Life Member!

Membership as of September 2, 2019

Honored Members	1
Life Members	116
Family Members	63
Single Members	68
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**248**

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Interested? Questions? Email us at info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. You can also join and renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

☐ New Membership

☐ Membership Renewal

☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*

☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*

☐ Life Membership *$200*

Name(s): _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

E-mail: _____

☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

☐ *I'd like a print-edition subscription to the newsletter (To save paper and costs, default subscription is digital emailed newsletter)*

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mountain View Historical Association
c/o Lisa Garcia
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Thank you!

FALL/WINTER

September 28

Saturday 9:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m.

Harvest History Festival

Heritage Park, 771 N. Rengstorff Ave.

October 6

Sunday 1:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m.

"Back to the Eagle Shack" + MVHA Fall Meeting

Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd.

See page 1 for more info

December 11

Wednesday 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.

MVHA Fall/Winter Board Meeting

M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.

All interested members welcome to attend!

February 9

Sunday 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.

MVHA Winter Event & Meeting

Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd.

Details in our next newsletter!

Looking Back: Photos from the Archive





Photos of "Fury" the eagle from old yearbooks



1975 eagle mural at Castro St. campus



Modern eagle mural at Los Altos High

In keeping with the "Back to the Eagle Shack" theme of our fall event, let's look back at the history of the eagle as a symbol of Mountain View. Since the 1930s, our community has rallied around the eagle as a high school mascot. Usually depicted as a bald eagle, the mascot was originally chosen by students at Mountain View Union High School (MVUHS) on Castro Street and eventually was nicknamed "Fury." The eagle complemented the school colors, blue and gray. The colors were chosen by students in 1902 to symbolize unity within the campus community; its first two graduates were descendants of Civil War soldiers, one a Northern "Blue" and the other a Southern "Gray." Over time, the eagle became a proud symbol of unity for the school's increasingly ethnically diverse student body.

When MVUHS closed in 1981, half of its student population was reassigned to arch-rival Los Altos High School. To ease the transition for the reassigned students, Los Altos High adopted the eagle mascot and blue and gray colors. Part of the old Castro Street campus became Eagle Park, named in honor of the mascot. Today, the generations of proud MVUHS Eagles from the beloved Castro Street campus are joined by an ever-growing number of "Mountain View" Eagles (i.e., people from the city of Mountain View) who are alumni of Los Altos High School. Either way, the eagle lives on!

EST. 1954

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
EMAIL: info@mountainviewhistorical.org

FIRST CLASS MAIL

Join the conversation on Facebook!
"Like" us at ***www.facebook.com/MVHistory***
for updates on MVHA Events, historic trivia,
and to interact with other members on-line.

Save a tree and see the newsletter in:
Full Color
E-mail **mvha.newsletter@gmail.com**
to receive the digital edition of our newsletter.